Over 80% of luxury hotel operators want to invest in Italy next.

Share of operators' preferences for luxury hotel investment over the next three years.



What does it take to deliver them?



Gabriele Maffezzini
Project & Development, EMEA

Source: Hospitality & Real Estate Observatory, presented at AURA Florence, Oct 2026

Italy is outrunning Europe.

Performance, capital and new five-star supply all point the same way.

+11.3%

hotel RevPAR in Italy in H1 2026, vs +3.0% in Europe

EUR 1.3bn

invested in Italian hotels in H1 2026, 53% above the 10-year average

+4.9%

five-star hotels in 2025, the fastest growth in Europe

~1,000

five-star hotels Italy could reach by 2030



Gabriele Maffezzini
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Sources: Cushman & Wakefield, Hospitality MarketBeat Italy H1 2026; industry observatory presented at AURA, Oct 2026

More openings. Almost no new rooms.

Over 80 hotels opened in Italy in H1 2026, yet supply grew only 0.2%. Growth comes from upgrading what exists.



FROM 4 STARS TO 5, IN THE SAME WALLS

35%
of H1 2026 investment went to upscale hotels

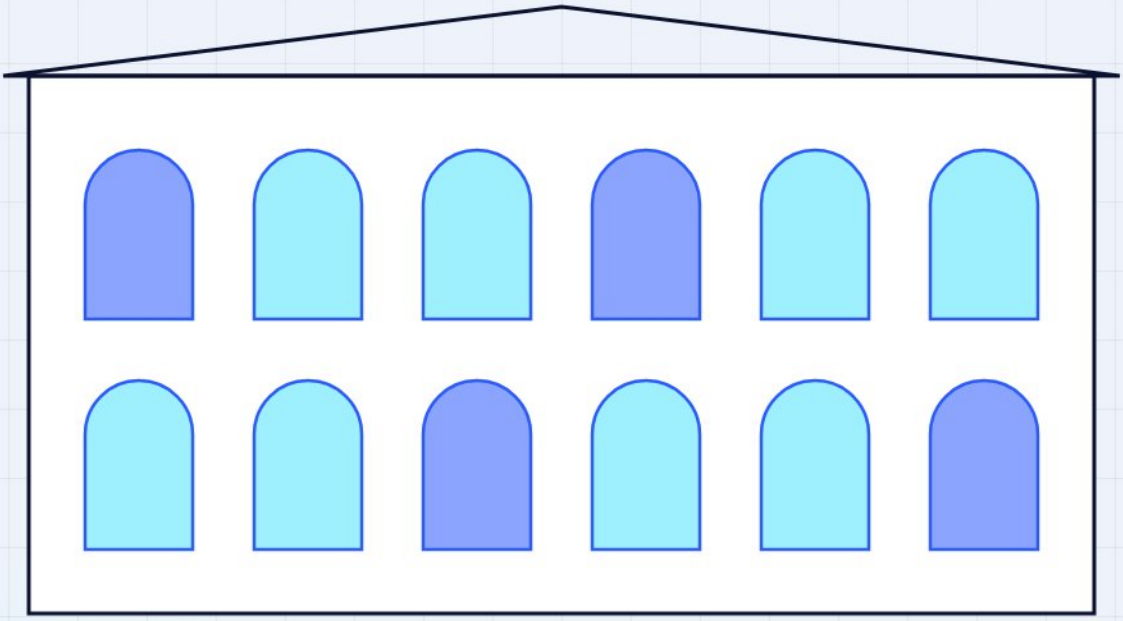
+127%
upscale volume, year on year



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Source: Cushman & Wakefield, Hospitality MarketBeat Italy H1 2026

The building is the brand.



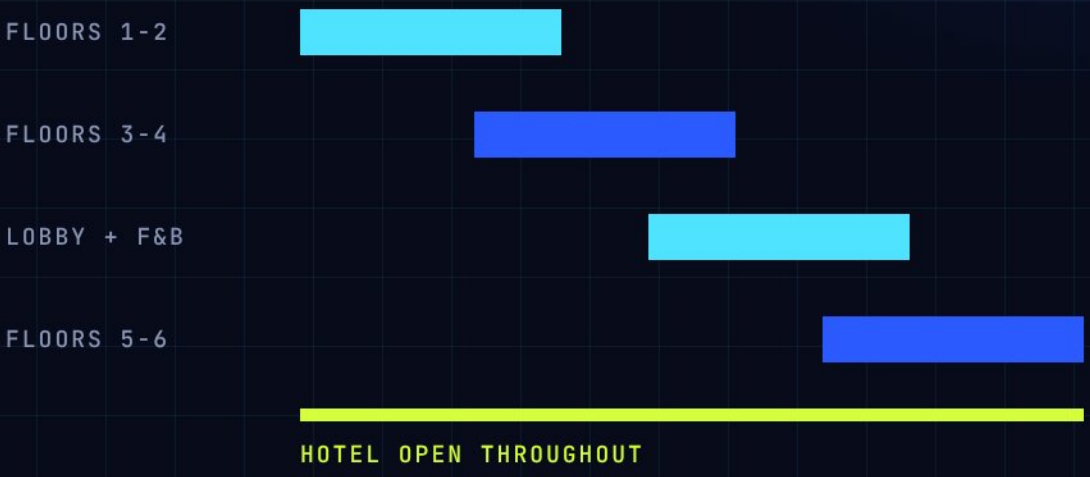
Palazzi, monasteries and former offices become hotels. Every survey, permit and structural check shapes the programme.



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Illustrative facade

In a hotel that never closes, the programme is the design.



68% to 73%
expected luxury occupancy, 2027 to 2029

~EUR 1,186
expected luxury average daily rate in 2029



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Source: Hospitality & Real Estate Observatory, presented at AURA Florence, Oct 2026

Hospitality is no longer a niche. It is core business.

Upgrade
4 stars to 5

Heritage
the building is the brand

Phasing
work while it stays open

What is the hardest part of a luxury repositioning?

Tell me from your projects.



Gabriele Maffezzini
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